

How a Camera works

People usually prefer digital cameras over conventional ones because the output is print-friendly, web-friendly, editable and inexpensive. However, going from film to digital isn't easy because there is a whole range of digital cameras available in the market today. Broadly, all digital cameras can be classified into two groups: P&S and dSLR.



The Sony Cybershot is a typical point and shoot digital camera



The Pentax K 100 D is an entry-level D-SLR

14.1 Difference between a P&S and a dSLR

The camera commonly flaunted and the one we popularly know as a 'digicam' is of the P&S variety. P&S stands for 'Point and Shoot' and they're called so for the obvious reason that all you need to do is point it at the subject and click.

So what exactly are the fundamental differences between the P&S and dSLR?

The Lens:

P&S cameras have lenses fixed to the camera body and integrate the shutter in to the lens. The lens of a digital camera, as with the traditional 35-mm camera, is of critical importance. Once you buy a compact digital camera, you're stuck with the lens you're provided. The best thing about dSLRs is that you can detach the lens with the press of a button and substitute it with any other lens to best suit the event.